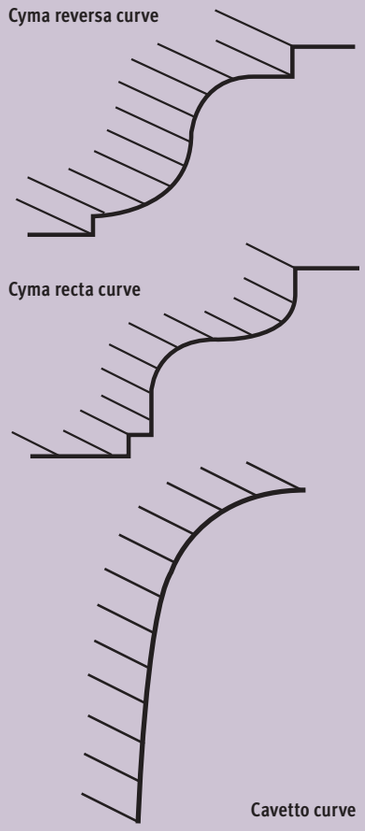
Glossary of names of shapes

Flutes and reeds run along a spindle

Ball: A spherical shape
Bead: Rounded shape usually slightly narrower than it is tall
Bird's beak: A half bead combined sharply with a scotia to form a shape similar to a bird's beak
Bobbin: A wider, stretched version of a bead
Bulnose: Sometimes known as a round-over is a held bead shape, usually found at the base of a turning, such as the oak lamp pictured above
Cavetto: A hollow shape that is a half cove or quarter of a circle
Cove: A hollow U shape
Cyma recta: An ogee shape where the concave part is at the top
Cyma reversa: An ogee shape where the convex part is at the top
Flute: A cove that usually runs along a spindle – this is currently under Reed, but should appear under its own heading
Necklace: A detail set down from the top detail on a spindle, often a bead, fillet an small scotia
Ogee: A flowing S-shape
Ovolo: A moulding similar to a bullnose but usually used as an edge mould, with a fillet either side of it to give definition – used as the edge mould on the four lids of my oak jewellery box
Pommel: The square section often found at the top of a furniture leg and at both ends of a stair spindle
Quirk: A V-shaped cut that separates and defines details
Reed: A group of narrow beads that usually run along a spindle
Reel: A stretched shallow cove
Ring: A narrow version of a bead
Sausage: A stretched bead shape with a straight portion and rounded ends that resembles a sausage
Scotia: A lopsided cove
Tulip: A shape made up of a combination of a round and hollow to form a shape loosely resembling the flower of a tulip ●

This lamp base features a turned bullnose detail

THREE COMMON CURVES



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